

HOW IS THE PROJECT GOING?

Answer A

"So we started the stakeholder mapping in the third week of March, and we were trying to get the sign-off from the legal team, which took a bit longer than expected because there were some questions around the compliance section. And then we had the Easter break, so that pushed things back. But we're pretty much on track now, mostly."

Answer B

"We are two weeks behind schedule due to a delayed legal sign-off. We have a plan to recover one week by Friday."

WHY IT MATTERS

"By the time you get to the point, they have already stopped listening."

A headline-first answer signals confidence, clarity, and respect for the listener's time.



BLUF OR CIRCLING? LABEL EACH ONE.

Example 1

"The budget figures came in this morning. After reviewing the travel line and the vendor costs, it looks like we are about 12% over the Q2 forecast."

Example 2

"We are 12% over the Q2 forecast. The travel line and vendor costs are the two main drivers."

Example 3

"The rollout is delayed by one week. An IT compatibility issue and incomplete regional briefings are the two causes."

Example 4

"We've had some challenges with the rollout. The IT team flagged a compatibility issue, and a few of the regional managers weren't fully briefed, so there were some delays last week."